

is due for release this month. Ubuntu Linux is an example of free software that can be used to spread awareness of a cause.

By default, Ubuntu comes with the GNOME desktop. There is also a KDE version available, called Kubuntu.

8.1.6 Knoppix

Knoppix is a Free and open source Live Linux CD derived from Debian. It contains commonly-used software such as OpenOffice.org, AbiWord, The GIMP, Konqueror, Mozilla, Apache, PHP, MySQL and many other open source programs. It runs completely from a CD, without the need for anything installed onto the hard disk. Due to on-the-fly decompression, the Live CD can hold up to 2 GB of software! On-the-fly decompression means the contents are extracted as they are being read, without the whole package being copied first to the hard disk.



Knoppix can be downloaded via BitTorrent, or can be ordered from a vendor. The download site is www.knoppix.org.

Knoppix also allows you to install to the hard disk and then multi-boot, but the installer interface is not intuitive. If you wish to install Knoppix on your hard disk, read the on-screen instructions *very* carefully—a wrong move can wipe all data off your hard disk!

8.1.7 Gentoo Linux

Gentoo is literally the name of a small, fast penguin found in the Falkland Islands. The “g” in “Gentoo” is a soft “g” as in “gentle”. One of the high points of Gentoo Linux is its customisability. With Gentoo, it is possible to build an entire system from source using a choice of optimisations and customisations. The user has complete control over the packages that can be installed. Gentoo is called a meta-distribution for the same reason.

